

based on the ‘freemium’ model – allowing a certain amount of free storage and then charging rent if the user exceeded that amount. This finally gets us to Google Drive.

At first glance, it is hard to see what Google Drive brought to the table that the others didn’t, but the fact of the matter was that Gmail was fast becoming the preeminent email service, and Google simply linked Google Drive to Gmail. So now the user didn’t have to worry about their online files because they were being backed up automatically. The added bonus of being able to share and edit files on the cloud itself wasn’t new, but being



Not only can users share their docs with each other, they can keep track of the changes being made in real time

able to do it simultaneously was. Google Drive allowed for a private, as well as a business workplace. When it first came out, they offered 15GB storage free, with 100GB available for just \$2 a month. It was perfect for students and home-run businesses. The plain fact of the matter was that it was easier to use than any of the previous services, especially for the average internet user.

The colours of the Google Drive rainbow

Now that both the idea behind Google Drive, and the long and illustrious history that led to its creation are known, let us take a look at its many features.

Starting with the most obvious - backup, Backup, BACKUP! Apart from uploading your data directly, you can also save attachments from